

SESSION 2

The Morning After & the Night of Lanterns

Your whole job: read the words · press the button · ask “What do you do?”

Pregame checklist

- Every device: close and reopen the app once (the last manual refresh ever)
- Run the Session 2 SQL paste (adds The Morning After beat + Tarn & Pip)
- Planning mode → tap “go here” on The Morning After
- Spotify: queue “the lakes (original version)” — single-repeat ON, autoplay OFF, volume tested
- iPad on the stage (ambient). Do NOT show the carnival map until they reach the gate
- The lantern box: five notes inside, matched to the right lanterns, box closed and hidden

PRESS (on your MacBook)

Nothing yet.

Tonight your buttons live in Run the Night — each scene shows its own.

THE NIGHT AT A GLANCE

Six scenes. One pacing rule.

0:00	The Morning After	Saltmere wakes to no sea · Billy’s reckoning · explore the town
1:15	The Lantern Box	Open the box. Hand each lantern over in silence.
1:40	The Gate	The Twins · one honest answer each, out loud — write them down
2:00	The Midway	Snail derby · Billy’s page · the Court’s crates
2:20	Grey-Gill’s Tent	She reads them their own confessions — the heart of the night
2:40	Carousel + Whispers	The missing note · five private visions in the dark
2:55	THE THREE GATES	The argument · <i>the lakes</i> · the crossing · Level 2 · blackout

THE ONE RULE: be walking across the sand by ~90 minutes in. Running long? End the session AT the gate — the Three Gates (and the song) open Session 3 instead.

Saltmere wakes to no sea

READ ALOUD *“Morning comes grey and wrong. The gulls stand in silent rows along the rooftops, all facing the sand. Where the sea should sound — nothing at all.”*

- Maddy’s free breakfast — “brawl champions eat on the house, loves”
- She returns their weapons → everyone re-equips in the Bag (one tap)
- Over breakfast, Griff arrives with the morning’s weight: Tarn → next slide
- Then the town is theirs until dusk — “Saltmere’s yours. Where do you go?”

PRESS (on your MacBook)



The silence where the sea was



The chapel bell (one soft note)

Tarn — Billy's reckoning

- The brawl: Billy's bottle shattered across the eyes of Tarn, a netmender. The glass took his sight.
- Saltmere's custom (Griff, gently): no jail, no mob — “the one who broke it sits with it.” The town expects Billy at Net Row.
- Tarn: calm hands, dry kindness, ZERO self-pity. “Sit down, lad. Skip to the end of the apology.”
- His boy Pip (9): all glare, no words. One real kindness to his da = fiercest ally forever.
- Restitution is Billy's to INVENT — coins, an oath, teaching Pip letters. Accept anything sincere.

If Billy dodges: no punishment, just weather — cold shoulders all day, and Pip follows the party, glaring.

PRESS (on your MacBook)

Nothing yet —

the button comes on the next slide, at the twist.

The glitter doesn't come out

- Let a Druid try Cure Wounds: cuts close — but a GLITTER stays in his eyes.
- The bottle was prize-stall glass. Carnival glass. Court glass. Say only: “the glitter doesn’t come out.”
- The twist — Tarn leans close to Billy: with his eyes dark, he SEES. The wheel of light on the sand. Paper tags on everything.
- “There’s one on you, lad. Yours says PENDING.” ← press the button as he says it
- For your eyes: Tarn is now the campaign’s true seer — one day the Court will offer to sell his sight back, with Billy’s guilt as the lever.

PRESS (on your MacBook)

☒ Billy: Tarn’s dark-sight

(in The Morning After scene)

The town, part 1

- MARKET: a fresh notice nobody remembers posting — “FOUND: one tide. Inquire below.”
- LIGHTHOUSE: Wick’s charts — the horizon is eleven feet CLOSER. “The sea didn’t go out. It got SMALLER.”
- HARBORMASTER: Griff’s tide logs — one page torn out, the week he was eight. He tore it himself, age nine.
- CHAPEL: the wave-bell, silent since the tide left. Touched, it gives ONE soft note. Waiting, not broken.
- CHANDLERY: sells anything except rope to people “going out there.” Free rope — if they promise, out loud, to come back.

PRESS (on your MacBook)



Chapel bell — when someone touches it

The town, part 2

- WIDOW'S WALK: a spyglass and a still-warm cup of tea, owner gone. Through the glass (DC 12): one motionless figure at the carnival gate, facing town. All day.
- NET ROW: a little girl — “The tide’s not lost. It went to the party. It’ll come home when the party’s over.”
- THE SALT SHED — Peaches’s moment: scratching inside. A moon-grey seal-pup, netted, terrified. It goes still the moment it sees HER.
- Freed, it hums THREE NOTES of the sea-song — with the hole in it — then flop-runs for the carnival lights.

PRESS (on your MacBook)

☒ Peaches: the shed song
(as the pup runs for the lights)

SCENE 1 · OPTIONAL SMALL BATTLES

If they want a scrap

- THE STRANDED THINGS — tide pools: three big pale crabs corner a fisher-kid. Giant Crab: AC 15 · HP 13 · +3 · 1d6+1 & grapple.
- They're beached and terrified, not evil — any clever herding plan (DC 10–12) works. The kid names a crab after the hero.
- THE WRECKERS — the stranded boats: two inlanders with prybars. Bandit: AC 12 · HP 11 · +3 · 1d6+1. They scare easily.
- Win or talk, they leak: “Fella inland pays for carnival glass. Old coins. Weird coins.” — the Court has agents ashore.

PRESS (on your MacBook)



Haymaker



Bottles & furniture

✂ Roll initiative → (go-table)

Solo moments (narrate quietly, one player)

- PEACHES: wet bare footprints cross her path on dry cobbles — mid-stride, they stop. The alligator stares at where they end.
- BILLY: a blank page blows against his leg and won't leave. Faint pencil: a seating chart. One chair circled.
- PHILIP: in a shop window, his reflection walks a half-step behind. When he stops dead — it takes one more step.
- FREYA: a stranger writing in a small book, watching her. The page: names she'd die for, with sums next to each. He apologizes. He's gone.
- FREYA MOON: every flower turns its head to face her. One in a window box is glass — with a tiny tag. Blank.

PRESS (on your MacBook)

No buttons — these are spoken.

Lean close. Say it quietly.

Let the table see you whisper.

The Lantern Box — the ritual

READ ALOUD *“The sun goes down behind the hills, and the carnival lights come UP. And drifting down the streets of Saltmere like they know the way — five paper lanterns. One for each of you.”*

- 1 · Read the words above. Then STOP TALKING.
- 2 · Bring out the closed box. Set it on the table. Open it slowly.
- 3 · Hand each player their lantern PERSONALLY, one at a time, in silence. Note attached.
- 4 · They read their notes privately. Don't rush anyone. Phones stay dark.
- 5 · When the last note lowers, ask each: “Why do you follow yours?”
- 6 · Their answers are the walk to the sand. Begin it.

The five notes are on the printable companion sheet — cut them out and box them before the session.

PRESS (on your MacBook)

Nothing digital.

This moment is paper, hands, and quiet.

That's the power of it.

A mile of shining sand

- Harbor stairs → wet sand → the path of reflected light → stranded starfish.
- If they freed the seal-pup: its flipper-tracks run alongside theirs.
- Keep it QUIET. Short sentences. Let the table hush itself.
- NOW upload the carnival map to the stage — the iPad becoming the carnival as they arrive is your reveal.

PRESS (on your MacBook)

 Stage → Map mode → upload the carnival map

 The sea breathes (far away)

The Gate of Paper Lanterns

- Brother Hush never speaks — write his slate lines on real scraps and HOLD THEM UP (3–5 words). Sister Hum half-sings everything.
- The toll: ONE honest answer each — at your real table, out loud, one player at a time.
- WRITE THE ANSWERS DOWN (Notes tab). They are Court paperwork. They return in Act 3.
- Slate: “ONE ANSWER. TRUE ONES ONLY.”

PRESS (on your MacBook)



Toll bell



Carnival chime

The Games of the Midway

- Everything glitters, nothing has a price tag, stall-keepers know their names.
- Run a snail derby on their phones — the go-table button.
- The prize stall pays Billy — among the scrip, a page in his mentor's hand. The ink looks RECENT.
- Sneaking behind the stall: crates addressed THE STILL COURT, BELOW — the same glass that took Tarn's eyes.

PRESS (on your MacBook)

🐌 Run the Snail Derby →

✉ Billy: the page

✨ Sparkle

Grandmother Grey-Gill's tent

- Warm gravel voice, shawl pinned high (gills). “You walked in on borrowed feet, child.”
- When she tries to name the Court: touch your throat, mime bubbles, look afraid. Once. Never explain.
- Fire the five reading whispers ONE AT A TIME — a beat of silence after each. Watch each face.
- Her lockbox (if they snoop): a receipt — RECEIVED: ONE NAME (GREY-GILL).

PRESS (on your MacBook)

✉ Peaches · ✉ Billy · ✉ Philip

✉ Freya · ✉ Freya Moon

 ·  between readings

The Carousel, then the dark

- CAROUSEL: the organ plays the sea-song with a HOLE in it. Every glass horse-eye faces the water.
- If anyone hums the missing note: three seconds of true silence at your table. Count them.
- WHISPERS IN THE DARK: lanterns dim — fire ALL FIVE vision whispers, then let them decide what to share.
- These scenes run themselves. Your job is to go slowly.

PRESS (on your MacBook)

- ☒ Peaches: the note is yours
- ☒ Freya Moon: the pendant stirs
then, in the dark —
- ☒ all five visions, one by one
- 💖 Heartbeat under it all

The Three Gates

1. **Read the gates:** GREEN lanterns & moss (the Bog) · SILVER & your own face (the Facets) · BLUE & stairs into waiting water (the Under-Sea). Slate: “ONE OPENS TONIGHT.”
2. **Start “the lakes” LOW** as the arguing begins. Say nothing about it. Let it loop.
3. **Let them argue FOR REAL.** Every road pulls at someone’s Lost Thing. Do not rescue them. Someone hears “we’ll come back for yours” — that sentence is the campaign.
4. **The moment they commit: TURN IT UP.** Press the Level-2 whisper. Then not one more word.
5. **Lanterns snuffed. Lights down.** The song plays them out. THE MUSIC ENDS THE SESSION — NOT YOU.

☒ *ALL: the Feywild notices — Level 2 blooms on every phone, mid-crescendo.*

Voices — posture over accents

Maddy	Hands on hips. “love” or “trouble.”	<i>“Eat. The sea’s gone, not the porridge.”</i>
Old Griff	Slow. Certain. Forty years of weather.	<i>“The tide got BOUGHT.”</i>
Tarn	Calm hands. Dry kindness. No self-pity.	<i>“Sit. Hold this net.”</i>
Wick	Unslept. Laughs at wrong moments.	<i>“You don’t LOSE eleven feet of horizon—”</i>
Hush & Hum	Slate scraps held up · half-sung fragments.	<i>Slate: “TRUE ONES ONLY.”</i>
Grey-Gill	Warm gravel. Bubbles at the Court’s name.	<i>“The cards have been asking.”</i>
Operator	Hums the broken song. Weeps. Notices neither.	<i>(answers mid-hum, never stops)</i>
The Appraiser	ABSENT. Empty chair. Coat on a hook.	<i>Everyone: “He’s out. Appraising.”</i>

Your five — and how to make their night

Peaches Aasimar Druid	Tail sold in the Under-Sea; the alligator is the only witness. She carries the sea’s missing note.	<i>The seal-pup · Grey-Gill knowing her · let her mothering matter.</i>
Billy Human Wizard	Mentor un-written page by page. Fears nobody stays when the mask drops.	<i>Tonight IS his arc: Tarn, then the page. Let sincerity WORK.</i>
Philip Halfling Fighter	Trained to kill, chose gentleness. The Court files his convictions.	<i>Put someone behind him. ASK HIS PLAYER: who was he following?</i>
Freya Fairy Fighter	Her vow (“no one I love suffers what I did”) reads as a STANDING OFFER.	<i>Let her menace be useful — wreckers fold at one look.</i>
Freya Moon Fairy Druid	Carries the Heartbloom Grove’s last blossom. The blight was a purchase.	<i>The chapel bell · the pendant · one big flashy spell moment.</i>

KEEP THIS OPEN NEAR THE END

Every press, in order

- 1 · Net Row, the twist → ☒ Billy: Tarn's dark-sight
- 2 · Salt shed, pup freed → ☒ Peaches: the shed song
- 3 · Midway → ☒ Billy: the page · 🍌 derby
- 4 · Grey-Gill → ☒ × 5, one at a time, slowly
- 5 · Carousel → ☒ Peaches · ☒ Freya Moon
- 6 · The dark → ☒ × 5 visions · 💗
- 7 · Three Gates, on commitment → 🎵 UP · ☒ ALL: Level 2

PANIC CARD

FEELING LOST?

Read the gold words again.

Press any button.

Ask: "What do you do?"

Need a minute? "Hold that thought — everyone else, what are you doing?"

Table lull? Draw a wonder.